

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 2

Suffixes -ian and -an



Today I am learning that **-ian** and **-an** can show a person or thing *connected with a field, group or place*.

1 Learn the Meaning

The suffixes **-ian** and **-an** often create words that show a **connection** to a job, field, group or place. Some are nouns; others can also be adjectives.

musician

person connected with music

suburban

relating to a suburb

historian

person connected with history

republican

relating to a republic

2 Build the Word

Use the base or related word to form a new **-ian** or **-an** word. Notice when the base spelling changes.

Base / related	Suffix	New word	Connection
music	-ian	_____	_____
magic	-ian	_____	_____
history	-ian	_____	_____
suburb	-an	_____	_____
republic	-an	_____	_____

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

At a community careers evening, Zara listened to a **musician** explain how practice turns ideas into performance. Nearby, a **historian** described how old letters and photographs can reveal what life was like in the past. A **magician** demonstrated a card trick, then explained that careful timing matters as much as surprise. In the reading corner, a **librarian** showed students how to locate biographies and reliable reference books. One display compared city and **suburban** communities, while another explored how people can be connected with a nation or region. Zara noticed words such as **Australian** and **Canadian** on a map. She began to see a useful pattern: many words ending in **-ian** or **-an** tell us that someone or something is connected with a field, group or place. The spelling is not always as simple as attaching the suffix without change, so Zara checked the related base word carefully. She recorded musician - music, historian - history, librarian - library and suburban - suburb in her morphology notes.



Highlight the **-ian** and **-an** words. Underline the **base or related word** when it appears nearby.

4 Word Detective

Choose one **-ian** or **-an** word from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write a target word from the passage.

- What **base or related word** can you identify?

- What connection does the whole word show?

- Write a word sum or explain any spelling change.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by their final suffix spelling.

musician

historian

magician

librarian

suburban

American

republican

Australian

Ends in -ian

Ends in -an

6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

- A historian is connected with _____

- Use an **-ian** or **-an** word in your own sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises **-ian** and **-an**
- ☐ Finds a base or related word
- ☐ Explains the connection shown
- ☐ Spells and uses derived words



Capture idea:

Find an **-ian** or **-an** word in a biography, map or information text. Record its base or related word and explain the connection.